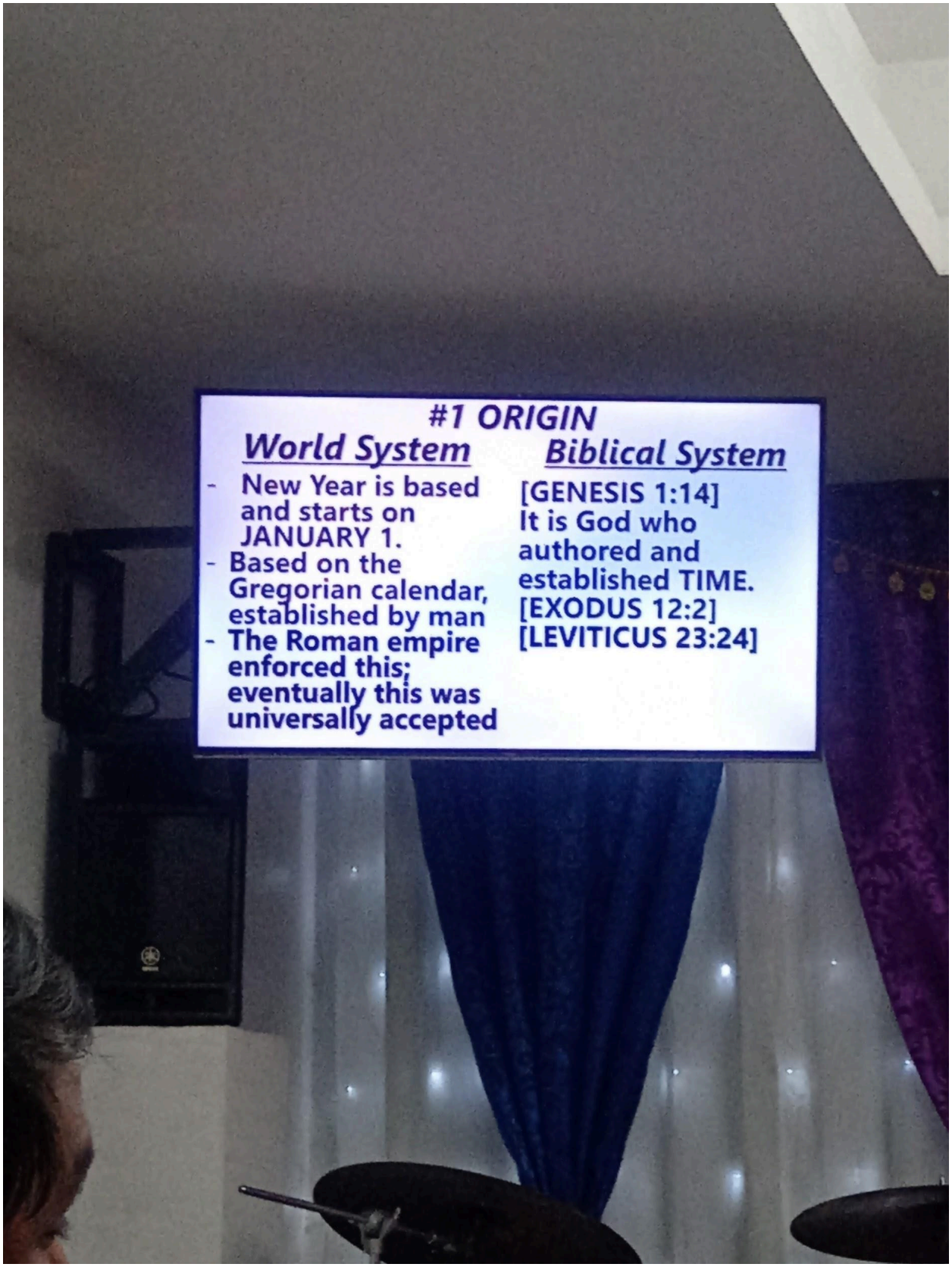
How should we celebrate the New Year?

Pastor Jec January 4,2026

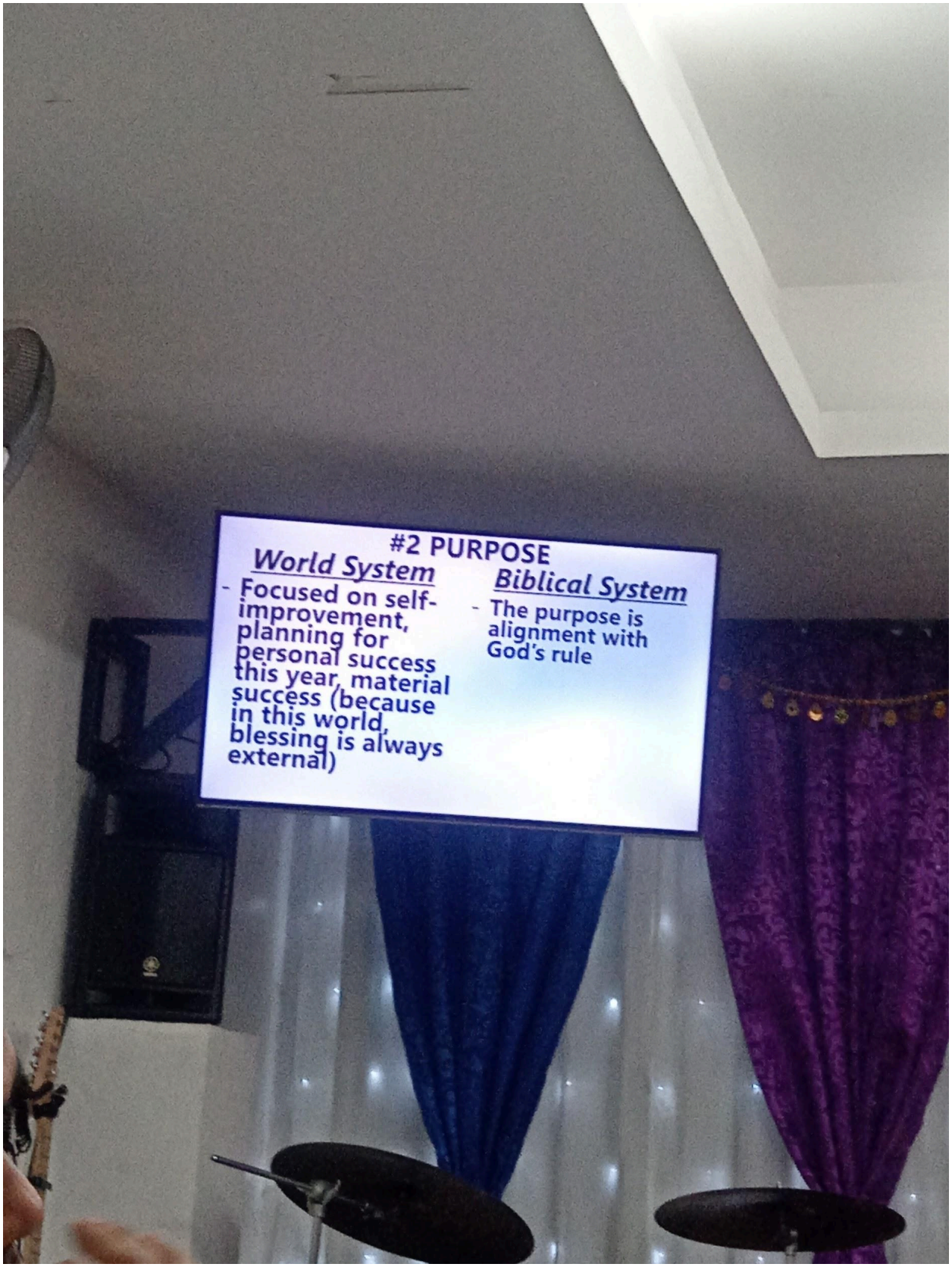
1. The Origin of the Celebration of the NEW YEAR

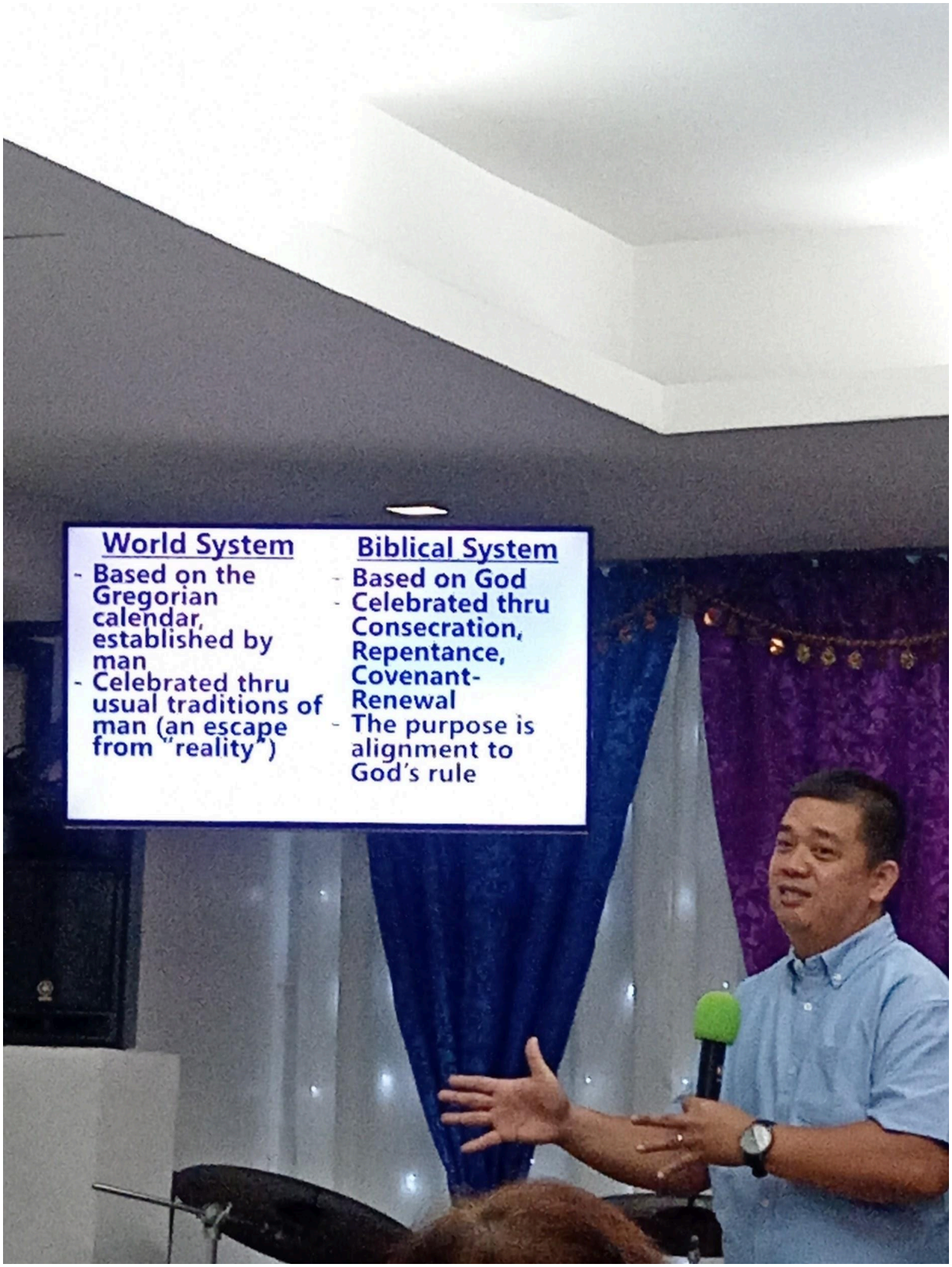
- **It is because of the Gregorian calendar. It is the Roman Empire who established this because during this time they were the dominant government.**
- **JANUARY 1: administrative purpose**

This established practice of celebrating New Year on January 1 was universally accepted, but this was only established by man, not by God.


#1 ORIGIN
World System
- New Year is based and starts on JANUARY 1.
- Based on the Gregorian calendar, established by man
- The Roman empire enforced this; eventually this was universally accepted
Biblical System
[GENESIS 1:14]
It is God who authored and established TIME.
[EXODUS 12:2]
[LEVITICUS 23:24]

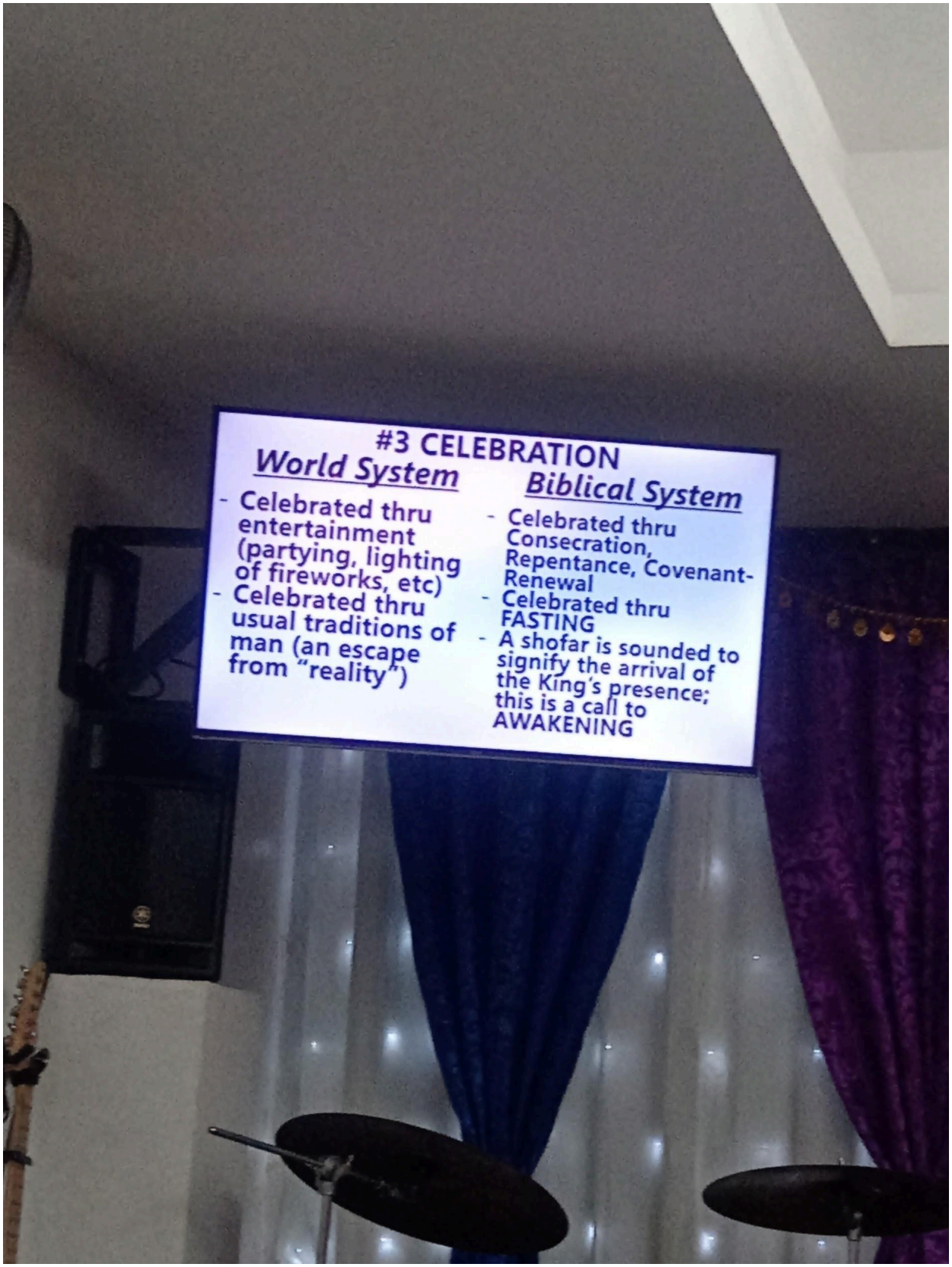
Galatians 4:4


#2 PURPOSE
World System
- Focused on self-improvement, planning for personal success this year, material success (because in this world, blessing is always external)
Biblical System
- The purpose is alignment with God's rule


World System
- Based on the Gregorian calendar, established by man
- Celebrated thru usual traditions of man (an escape from "reality")
Biblical System
- Based on God
- Celebrated thru Consecration, Repentance, Covenant-Renewal
- The purpose is alignment to God's rule

"Naka-align ba ako sa Hari?"
"Ano ang naging tugon ko sa Kanyang katapatan?"

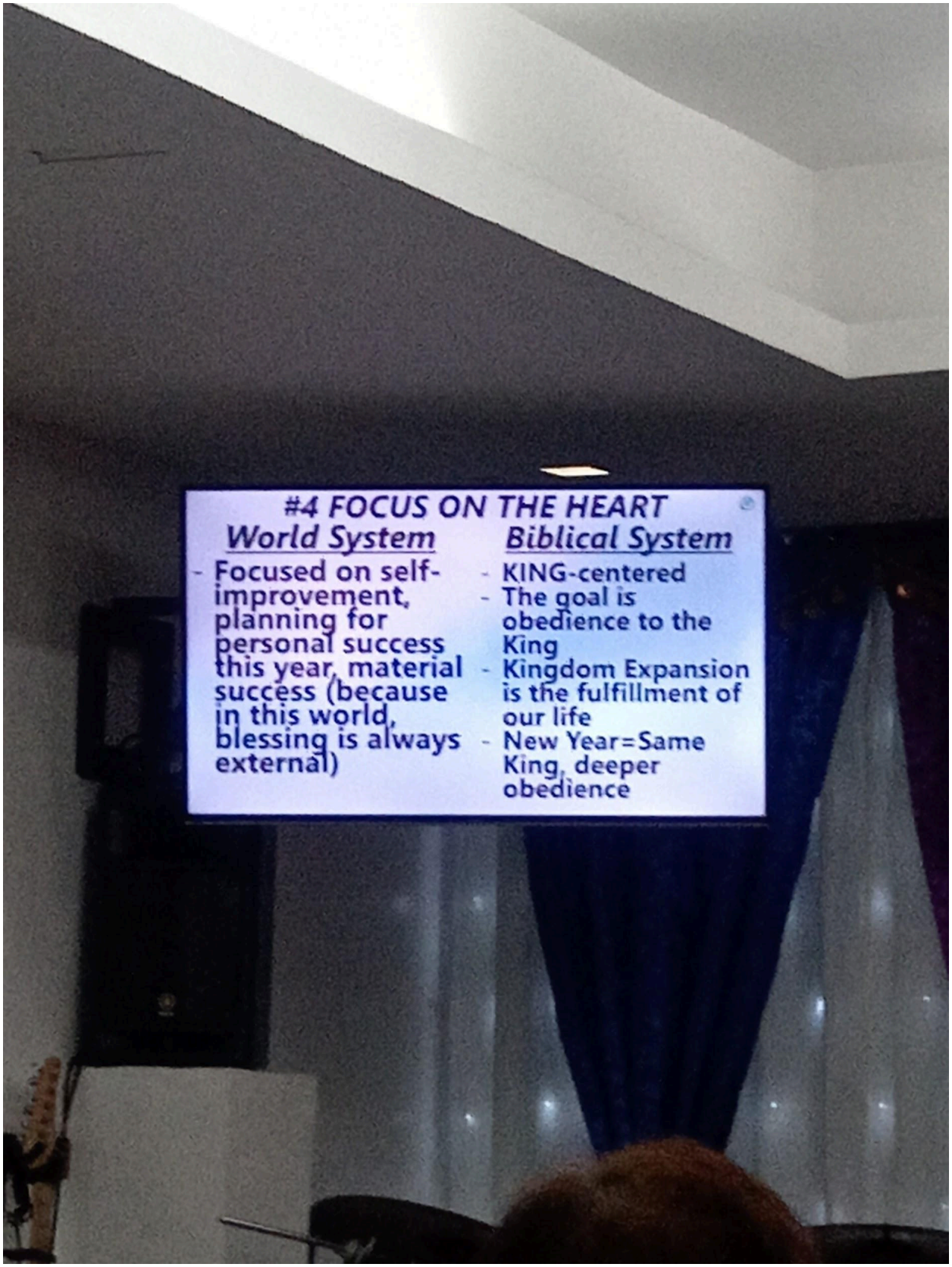
3. CELEBRATION



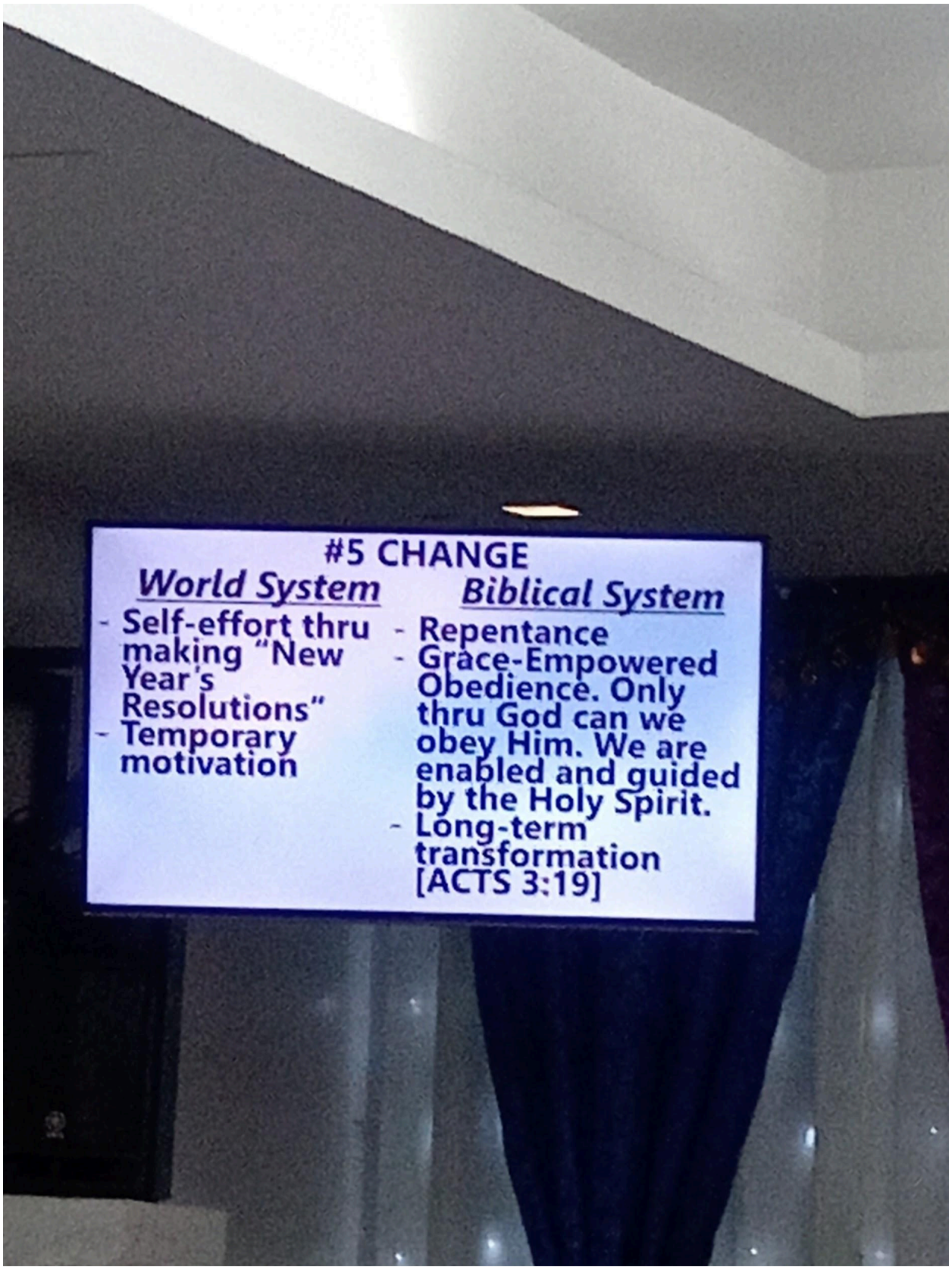
LEVITICUS 23:24

Tishrei - a time of realignment
Repent and renew your mind. Align to God's will.

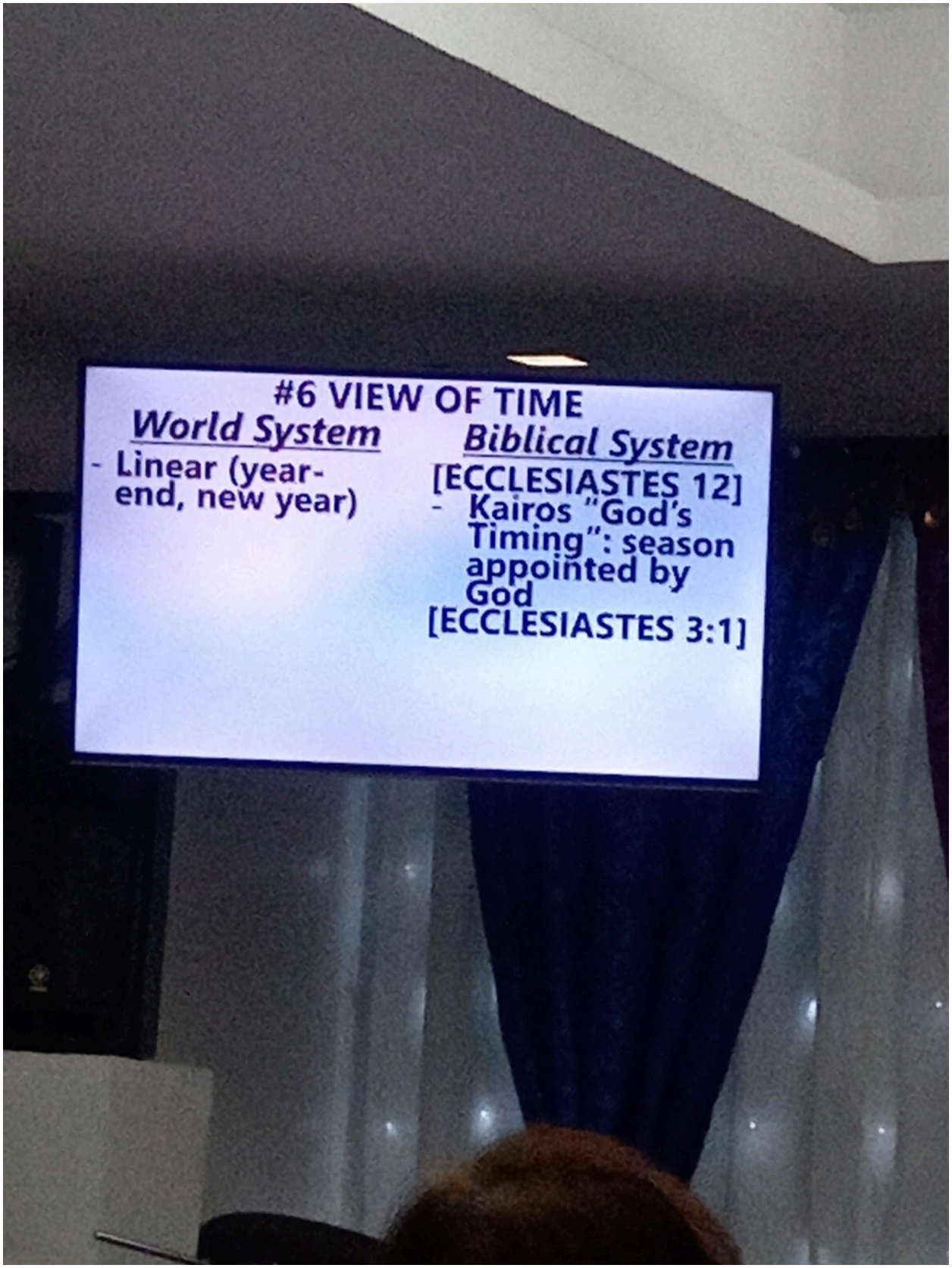
4. **Focus on the heart**


#4 FOCUS ON THE HEART
World System
- Focused on self-improvement, planning for personal success this year, material success (because in this world, blessing is always external)
Biblical System
- KING-centered
- The goal is obedience to the King
- Kingdom Expansion is the fulfillment of our life
- New Year=Same King, deeper obedience

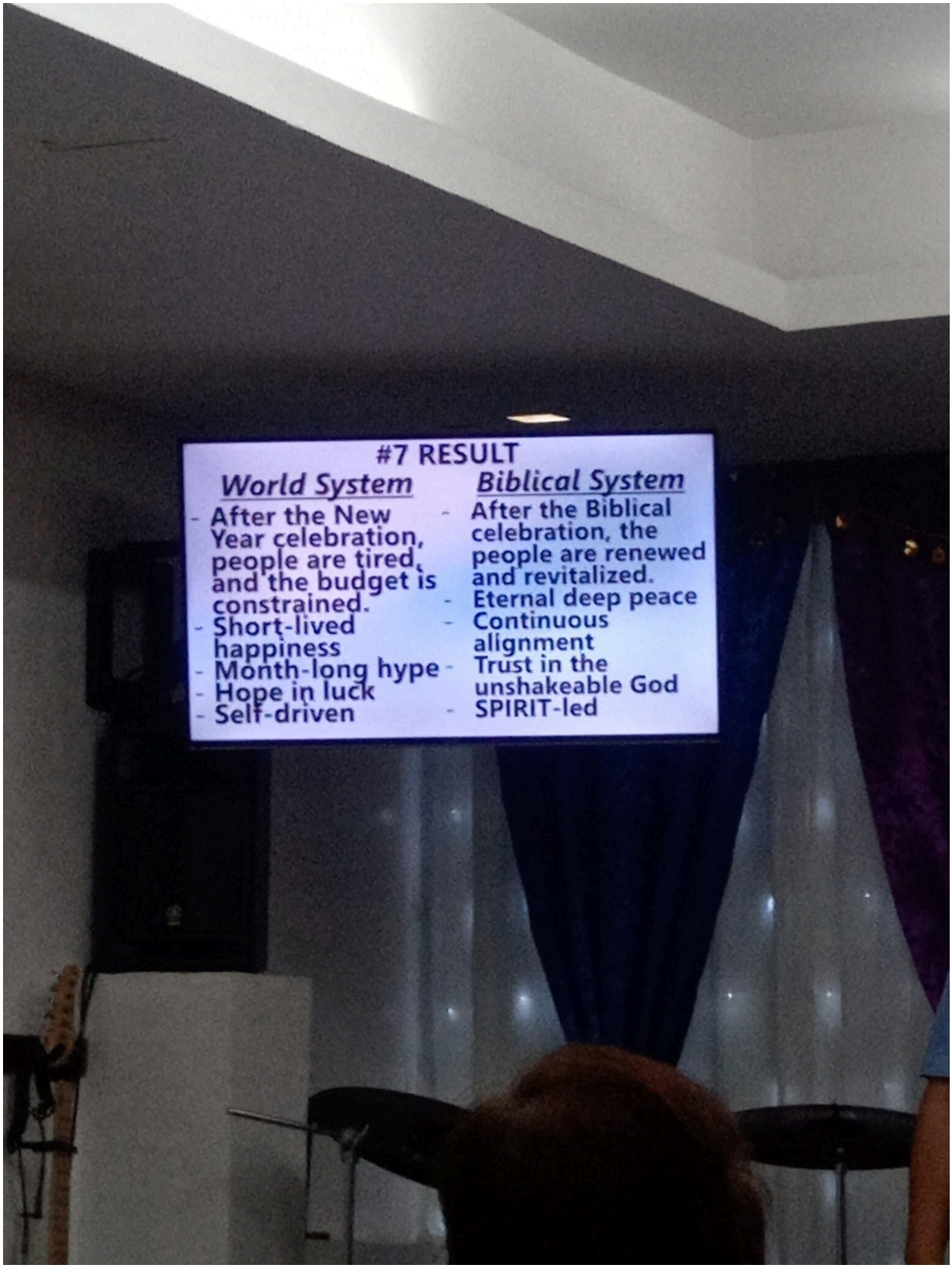
5. **Change**

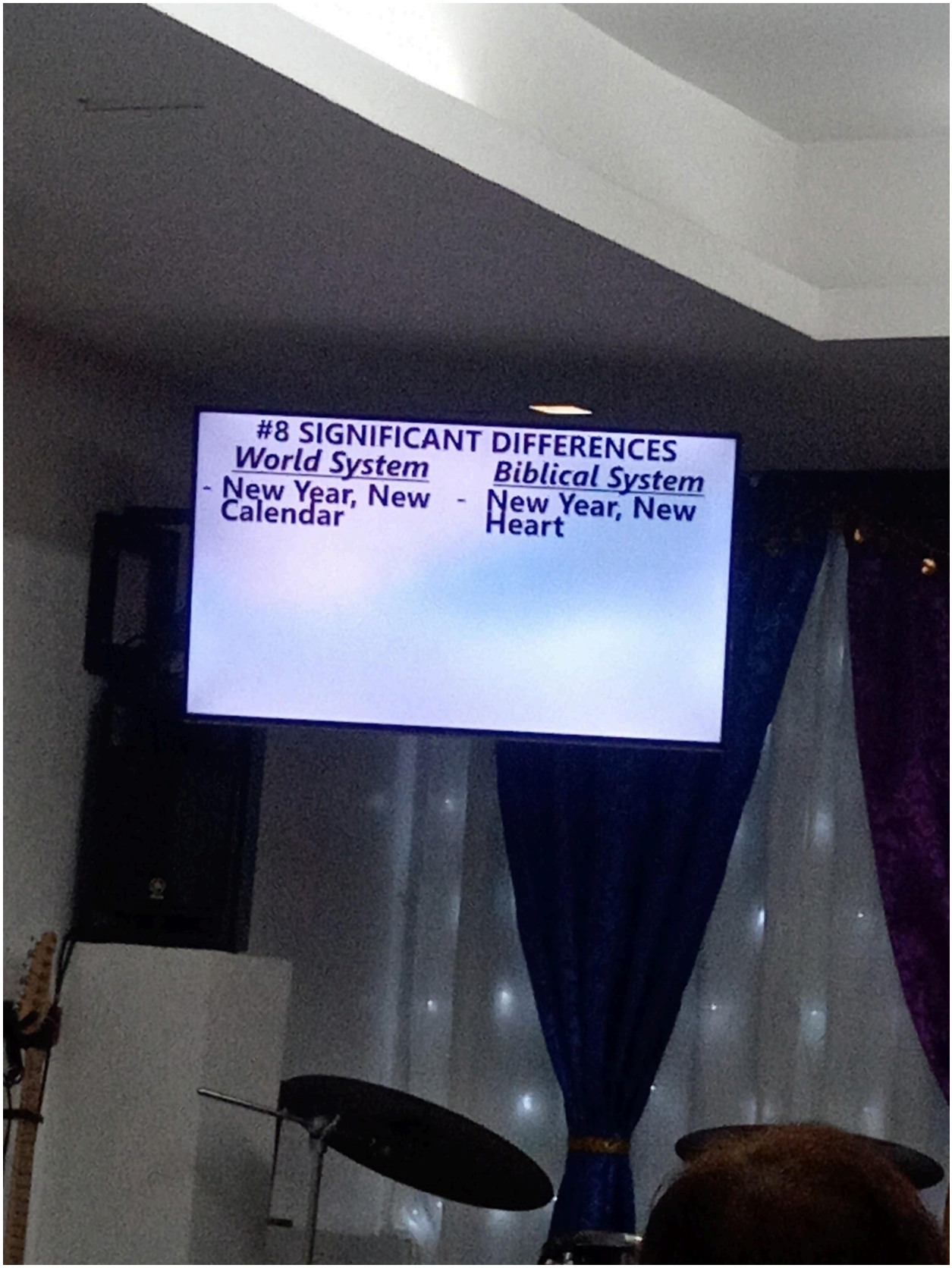

#5 CHANGE
World System
- Self-effort thru making "New Year's Resolutions"
- Temporary motivation
Biblical System
- Repentance
- Grace-Empowered Obedience. Only thru God can we obey Him. We are enabled and guided by the Holy Spirit.
- Long-term transformation [ACTS 3:19]

6. **VIEW OF TIME**



We are canceling the "Monday nanaman" concepts in this community. Not only TGIF, we are grateful to God for each day.


#7 RESULT
World System
- After the New Year celebration, people are tired, and the budget is constrained.
- Short-lived happiness
- Month-long hype
- Hope in luck
- Self-driven
Biblical System
- After the Biblical celebration, the people are renewed and revitalized.
- Eternal deep peace
- Continuous alignment
- Trust in the unshakeable God
- SPIRIT-led


#8 SIGNIFICANT DIFFERENCES
World System
- New Year, New Calendar
Biblical System
- New Year, New Heart

VISION of the Kingdom of God
Vision The Creator-King's ultimate goal for His creation.

Vision:
A restored creation under the full rule of God where His will is perfectly done on earth as it is in heaven, with mankind reigning as His royal sons and ambassadors.

BIBLICAL BASIS: Gen. 1:26-28, Ps. 24:1, Dan. 7:27, Hab. 2:14, Rev. 21-22

MISSION of the Kingdom of God
Mission The ongoing assignment to bring the King's vision to reality.

Mission:
To make the Kingdom visible on earth by restoring people to the rule of God through the gospel of the Kingdom, discipleship, and the demonstration of Kingdom culture.

BIBLICAL BASIS: Matt. 417, Lk. 4.43, Matt 28.18-20, Matt 6:33. Acts 13.18